

no alternative sources of information. They do not have the labour rights that were painstakingly negotiated for the workforce before them. Unfortunately, labour law reform appears to be favouring reduced labour rights for the entire workforce.

Without enforceable data protection laws and strong consumer laws, Indians are also vulnerable to harm resulting from Generative AI chatbots. The major AI companies are offering these tools for free in India, which allows them to study and experiment on several Indians with minimal consequences. Without carefully enforced privacy and consumer laws, large-scale harm is almost inevitable. It is just a question of time before these products start to target harmful content at their users, inciting harm. The law needs to regulate them preventively and clarify how users can seek redressal. As other major countries also struggle to regulate AI products, India should step up.

This begs the question of how. There are short-term answers to this question in the form of policy proposals that the government is already considering, such as making AI companies pay for content that they use to train their models. It could do much more to protect labour, the environment and data, and regulate harmful AI products, and it should ally with other countries taking on global leadership roles as it does so. The increasing use of AI necessitates transnational legal norms.

More work is needed to anticipate and avoid AI's less foreseeable harms, and to harness its potential for Indian society. For this, along with investment in science, there must be investments in studying society and in attracting excellent faculty. Questions of AI are not questions of technology, but are questions of the interaction between technology and society. Indian society is complex and interesting, which makes research on technology here relevant for the world. With the right resources, scholars can not only study how India is affected by technology but also how technology can benefit us.

> TO HARNESS OUR FULL POTENTIAL IN THE AI SOCIETY, POLITICAL LEADERS NEED TO **MARCH TO THE SOUND OF INDIA'S DRUM**, NOT TO THE RHYTHM OF THE FOREIGN, BIG TECH AI FIRMS

To harness our full potential in the AI society, political leaders need to march to the sound of India's drum, not to the rhythm of foreign AI firms. They are visibly trying, but it is difficult to access vision and imagination without investing in a range of perspectives—including critical ones—that present political leaders with all the potential outcomes and opportunities that might arise when this new technology meets society. They need a range of knowledge, options and voices if they are to come up with a legal framework tailored for our complex society. ■

Chinmayi Arun *is Executive Director, Information Society Project, and research scholar at Yale Law School*